

CASE STUDY

Building marketing and fundraising infrastructure for a community music series.

Client	Crabtree Sessions
Industry	Arts & Culture / Nonprofit
Location	North Haven, ME
Year	2025–2026

THE CHALLENGE

Strong programming, manual systems.

Crabtree Sessions had the ingredients of a thriving community institution — strong programming, a loyal audience, and an established artistic reputation. As they established themselves as a new non-profit, the team needed infrastructure to support a successful sixth season without adding complexity.

STARTING STRENGTHS

- › Large email list of past attendees
- › Strong, engaged Instagram presence
- › \$35K in organic donations (2025)
- › Strong artistic identity, loyal audience

CORE GAPS

- › Disconnected email, ticketing, donation platforms
- › No CRM or donor management system
- › No repeatable marketing or campaign framework

THE GOAL

Build systems that scale without complexity.

Design a modern marketing stack and operational backbone that could sustain the series long-term — connecting email, CRM, donations, and ticketing into one team-friendly workflow built for a small, volunteer-supported organization.



Six workstreams, one connected system.

01

Business & Revenue Strategy

2026 business plan with a \$90K revenue target across ticket sales, donations, grants, and season passes.

02

Email Marketing System

Mailchimp integrated with Givebutter CRM via Zapier. Templates and engagement calendar for newsletters, events, and appeals.

03

CRM & Donor Management

First centralized donor database. Stewardship workflow with post-event follow-up and team training.

04

Website & Conversion

Full website refresh aligned to campaign messaging. Clear pathways to tickets, donations, and event discovery.

05

Pitch Deck Development

Artist deck communicating audience profile and venue experience. Sponsorship deck for local and regional partners.

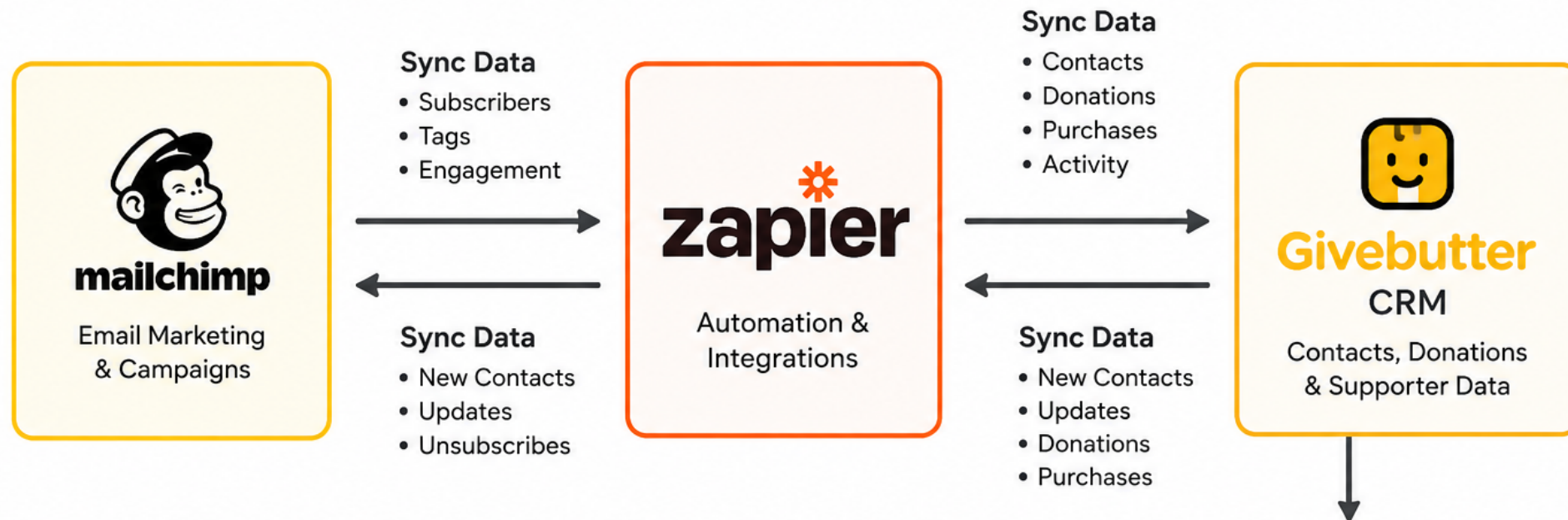
06

Operational Workflows

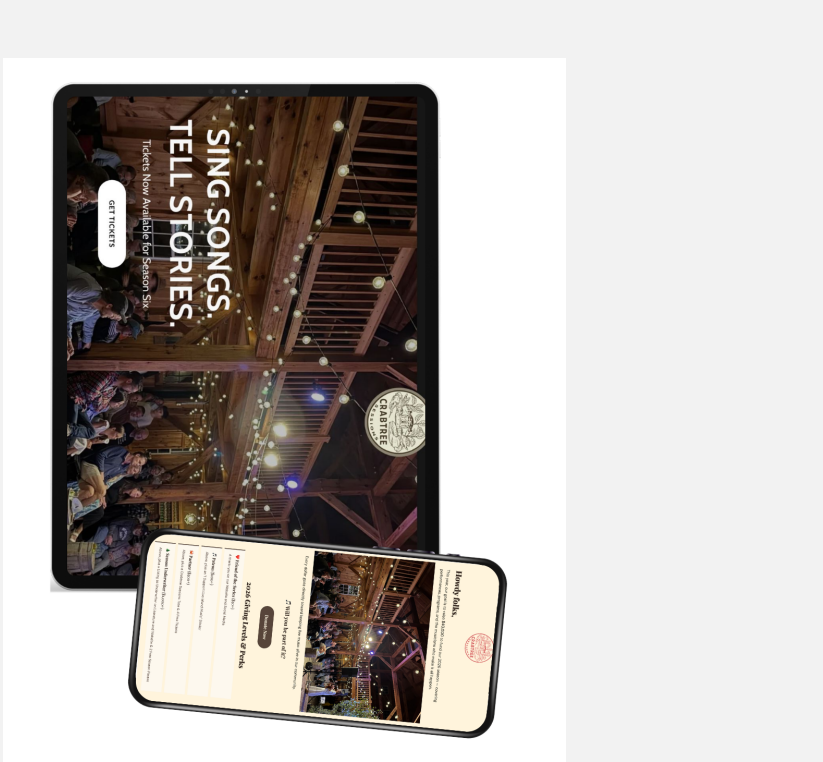
Repeatable workflows for events, attendance tracking, and revenue reporting. Templates to support volunteer onboarding.

THE SYSTEM

Connecting the marketing stack.



Brand alignment from inbox to investor deck.



Website & Donation Experience

Refreshed site with clear paths to tickets and donations, optimized for desktop and mobile.



Sponsorship Pitch Deck

Branded deck structuring partnership tiers for local and regional sponsors.

RESULTS

Infrastructure that's already paying off.

\$4,000+

Raised on Giving Tuesday to prepare for season
6

\$3,450

Pre-launch donations before the season lineup
was announced

60%

Email open rates across campaigns

5%

Click-through rates, surpassing nonprofit
benchmarks

First

Centralized donor database and CRM
established

\$90K

2026 revenue target with grants and benefit show
as new income streams

KEY TAKEAWAYS

What this work taught us.

1

Build the infrastructure before the growth.

Operational systems and scalable marketing have to come first — not after the audience outpaces them.

2

Donor relationships first.

For an intimate, community-centered nonprofit, the digital relationship has to match the in-person experience. Branding alignment and curated music in email nurtured the connection between IRL and online.

3

Small teams need systems built for independence.

Connecting email, website, and CRM meant the team didn't have to worry about reaching the right people — the system did.

GET IN TOUCH

Need help building marketing systems for your organization?

I work with mission-driven teams to design marketing and operational systems that scale without adding complexity.

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